

VPN Connectivity Troubleshooting

Sample IT Support Runbook | Category: VPN

1. Purpose and Symptoms

Use this runbook when a staff member cannot connect to the company VPN. Common symptoms include a connection timeout, a client that stays on Connecting, or repeated requests to reconnect. Confirm the user can reach an ordinary public website before troubleshooting the VPN.

2. Initial Checks

1. Confirm the device has a working internet connection.
2. Ask whether the user is on guest, hotel, or airport Wi-Fi. If so, open a browser and complete that network's sign-in page first.
3. Confirm the device date and time are correct.
4. Ask the user to disconnect the VPN client, wait 10 seconds, and try once more.

3. Refresh the VPN Client

If the connection still fails, fully quit and reopen the approved VPN client. Select the organization entry from the managed connection list; do not enter a gateway supplied by an unverified source. If the client reports an outdated profile, use the organization's approved device-management process to refresh it. Do not delete certificates or change security settings.

4. Sign-in and Verification

Have the user sign in through the organization's normal authentication page and approve the expected multi-factor prompt on their own enrolled device. Never ask the user to disclose a password or one-time code. If the prompt was not initiated by the user, deny it and report it to the security team.

VPN Connectivity Troubleshooting (continued)

5. Escalation

If the issue remains after the checks above, collect the error wording, approximate time, client version, operating system, and whether other users are affected. Do not include passwords, authentication codes, or private keys in the ticket. Attach the approved diagnostic bundle if policy permits, then assign the incident to the Network Support queue.

6. Completion

Ask the user to confirm access to an approved internal resource. Record which checks were completed and the outcome in the incident work notes. This sample runbook contains no real account details or production network addresses.